ALLAMAHUL BAYAN SERIES · BOOK 77

عَلَّمَهُ الْبَيَانَ

My First Sesotho Alphabet

Alfabete ya ka ya pele ya Sesotho

A Coloring Book to Learn, Trace & Say the 22 Sesotho Letters with English Phonetics

A a B b D d

Written by Hafez Abdullah Muhammad Minhaz Reza

Illustrations: AI-assisted, edited by the author

Maktabatu Kunujul Akhirah

مكتبة كنوز الآخرة

REVIEW DRAFT — not for publication

REVIEW DRAFT — DO NOT PUBLISH YET. The letter names, sound guides, words, transliterations and phrases in this book were drafted with AI and have not yet been checked by a native speaker. After review, set `draft=False` in the language file and rebuild; this notice then disappears.

My First Sesotho Alphabet — Alfabete ya ka ya pele ya Sesotho
Allamahul Bayan Series, Book 77

Text copyright © 2026 Hafez Abdullah Muhammad Minhaz Reza. All rights reserved.
No part of this book may be reproduced, stored or shared in any form without written permission from the publisher, except that parents and teachers may copy pages for use with their own children or class.

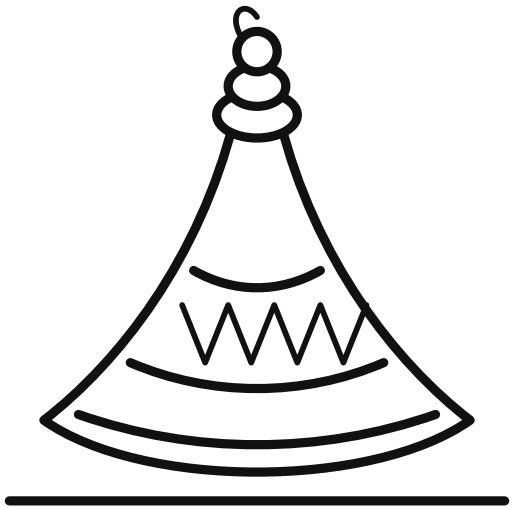
Published by **Maktabatu Kunujul Akhirah** (مكتبة كنوز الآخرة),
An imprint of the Kunujul Akhirah Charitable Trust, Bangladesh.
Contact: minhaz.reza87@gmail.com

First edition, 2026.

Illustrations: line art created with AI assistance and reviewed by the author. In keeping with the publisher's guidelines, the pictures show objects, plants and nature only — no people or animals.

Fonts: Baloo 2, Fredoka, Nunito, Amiri and Dancing Script, all under the SIL Open Font License. **Map data:** Natural Earth (public domain).

A note of respect: this book contains verses of the Noble Qur'an (pages 4–5). Please handle it with care and keep it in a clean place.



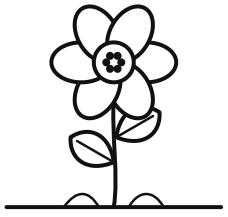
This book belongs to

Buka ena ke ya

I started learning Sesotho on







ABOUT THIS SERIES

The Allamahul Bayan Series

عَلَّمَهُ الْبَيَانَ

ʿallamahul-bayān — "He taught him clear expression"

الرَّحْمَٰنُ ﴿١﴾ عَلَّمَ الْقُرْآنَ ﴿٢﴾ خَلَقَ الْإِنسَانَ ﴿٣﴾ عَلَّمَهُ الْبَيَانَ ﴿٤﴾

Ar-Raḥmān. ʿAllamal-Qurʾān. Khalaqal-insān. ʿAllamahul-bayān.

"The Most Merciful. He taught the Qur'an. He created the human being. He taught him clear expression (al-bayān)."

Surah Ar-Raḥmān 55:1–4[1]

Surah Ar-Raḥmān — the chapter of *The Most Merciful* — opens by naming some of Allah's greatest gifts to us. First, **He taught the Qur'an**. Then, **He created the human being**. And then, **He taught him al-bayān**.

What does *al-bayān* mean? It comes from an Arabic root that means *to make something clear*. Al-bayān is the gift of speech and understanding: being able to put what is in our hearts and minds into words, to explain, to listen, and to be understood. Animals make sounds, but only people were taught to speak, read and write in languages. Scholars of tafsīr explain that this gift is what lets us learn, teach and pass on guidance — including the Qur'an itself.

So every time a child says a new word, sounds out a letter, or writes their first line in a new language, they are using a gift that Allah Himself says He taught. That is the heart of this series: **learning languages as a way of thanking Allah for al-bayān.**

Languages and colours: two signs of Allah

وَمِنْ آيَاتِهِ خَلْقُ السَّمَاوَاتِ وَالْأَرْضِ وَاخْتِلَافُ أَلْسِنَتِكُمْ وَأَلْوَانِكُمْ ۚ إِنَّ فِي ذَٰلِكَ لَآيَاتٍ لِّلْعَالِمِينَ ﴿٢٢﴾

Wa min āyātihī khalqus-samāwāti wal-arḍi wakh-tilāfu alsinatikum wa alwānikum. Inna fī dhālika la-āyātil-lil-ʿālimīn.

"And among His signs is the creation of the heavens and the variety of your languages and your colours. Surely in that are signs for those who know."

Surah Ar-Rūm 30:22[1]

In Surah Ar-Rūm, Allah tells us that the **many languages** of people and their **many colours** are among His signs. A coloring book that teaches a language brings both of these signs together in a child's hands: they meet a new language, and they fill its letters with colour.

وَجَعَلْنَاكُمْ شُعُوبًا وَقَبَائِلَ لِتَعَارَفُوا

Wa jaʿalnākum shuʿūban wa qabāʾila li-taʿārafū.

"...and We made you into peoples and tribes so that you may get to know one another."

Surah Al-Ḥujurāt 49:13 (part)[1]

Allah made us into many peoples *so that we may get to know one another*. Learning even a few letters of someone's language is a beautiful first step towards knowing them.

How each book in the series works

Every book introduces one language **through English**:

- where the language is spoken, with a map to color;
- every letter of its alphabet, with its name in the language itself *and* in English letters;
- simple English sound guides, so a parent who has never heard the language can still help;
- a word and picture for every letter, to color, trace and say out loud.

Book 77 is Sesotho. More languages from around the world are in the series, in shā' Allāh.

FOR PARENTS AND TEACHERS

How to use this book

Begin with **Bismillah**, and go **little and often**: one letter a day is plenty for a young child. For each letter:

1. **Say it.** Read the letter's name and its sound guide together. Say it three times.
2. **Color it.** Color the big letter any way your child likes.
3. **Trace it.** Trace the dotted letters with a pencil, then try one alone in the empty boxes.
4. **Meet the word.** Say the word, color the picture, and talk about it in English.

Marker tip: every coloring page has a blank back, so colours cannot spoil the next activity. Slip a sheet of scrap paper behind the page you are coloring anyway — it keeps the next page clean.

Reading the English sound guides

- **CAPITALS** show the stressed syllable: *POO-lah* means "say POO a little louder". Sesotho is also a tone language, so listen to a Sesotho speaker for the tune of each word.
- **(click)** marks the Q click: pop your tongue off the roof of your mouth.
- **kh** is a throaty sound, like the Arabic letter خ; **hl** is air blown past the sides of the tongue.
- **m-** or **n-** before another consonant is a short hum: *nngwe* (one) is "N-ngweh".

Three ways to see every sound

Each letter page shows the sound three ways: the letter's **Sesotho name** written in Sesotho (native phonetics), the **same name in English letters**, and an **English sound guide**. The box marked *Sesotho name · syllables* shows a simple name for the letter (B is «ba») and its row of syllables — the way Sesotho children practise reading.

The pronunciation guides are simplified for young learners and follow Sesotho as written in South Africa (Lesotho spells some words a little differently).

MEET THE LANGUAGE

Hello, Sesotho! Sesotho

seh-SOO-too — the Sesotho word for the language

Who speaks it?
About **6 million people** speak Sesotho as their first language, and millions more use it as a second language.[3]

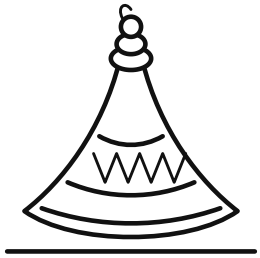
Where?
In **Lesotho**, a mountain country in southern Africa, and in **South Africa** — around Bloemfontein, Johannesburg and the Free State.

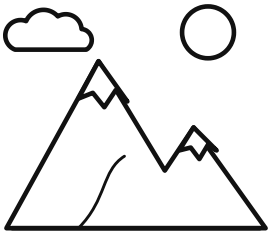
How is it written?
In the **Latin alphabet**, from **left to right**. Lesotho and South Africa spell a few sounds differently: *lipalesa* and *dipalesa* are the same word, "flowers".

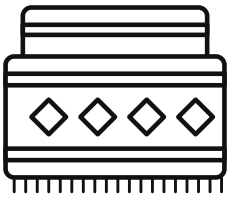
How many letters?
22 letters: A B D E F G H I J K L M N O P Q R S T U W Y.

The Kingdom in the Sky
All of Lesotho is high up in the mountains. Its **lowest** point is higher than the lowest point of any other country in the world — and snow falls there in winter!

Did you know?
The **mokorotlo**, a hat woven from grass, is shaped like the mountain Qiloane. Basotho families also wrap up in warm, colourful woollen **blankets**.





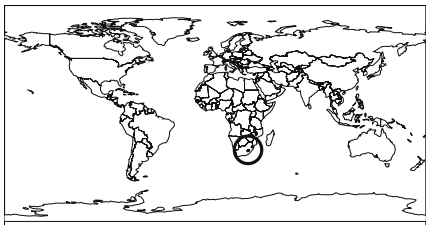


The Sesotho Alphabet alfabete

22 letters – alfabete ya Sesotho

Aa *ah*	**Bb** *bah*	**Dd** *dah*	**Ee** *eh*	**Ff** *fah*	**Gg** *gah*
Hh *hah*	**Ii** *ee*	**Jj** *jah*	**Kk** *kah*	**Ll** *lah*	**Mm** *mah*
Nn *nah*	**Oo** *oh*	**Pp** *pah*	**Qq** *(click) ah*	**Rr** *rah*	**Ss** *sah*
Tt *tah*	**Uu** *oo*	**Ww** *wah*	**Yy** *yah*		

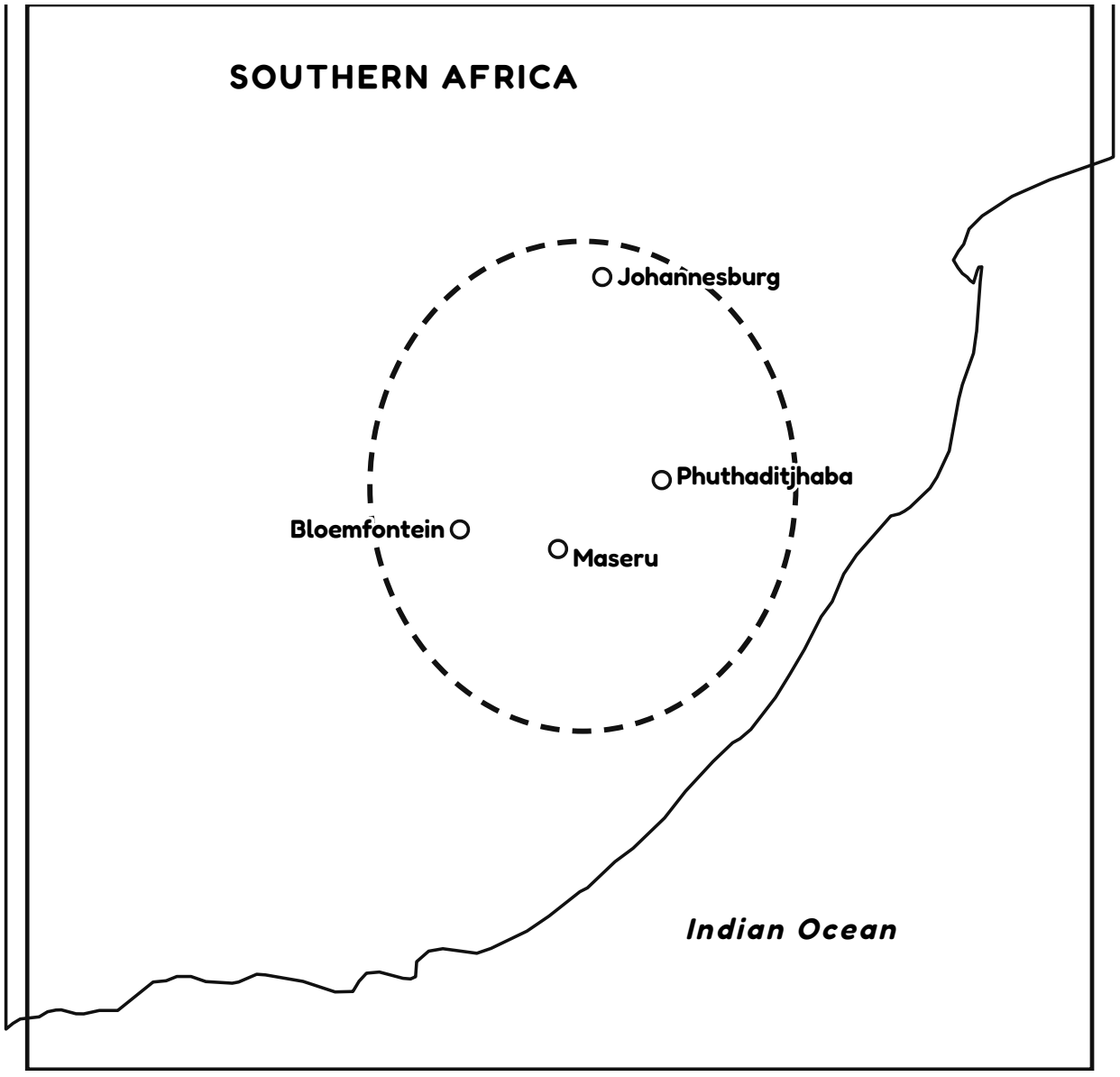
Read the alphabet row by row — the same order as in this book.



The circle shows Lesotho and South Africa on the world map.

COLOR THE MAP

Where is Sesotho spoken?



Color it: the land **green** · the ocean **blue**. **Find it:** Sesotho is spoken in Maseru, Bloemfontein, Phuthaditjhaba and Johannesburg. The dashed line shows where most Sesotho speakers live.

This page is left blank on purpose, so your colours don’t bleed through. ✿

THE LETTERS

The Letters alfabete ya Sesotho

ahl-fah-BEH-teh yah seh-SOO-too — “the Sesotho alphabet”

Sesotho is written with **22 letters**. It has no C, V, X or Z.

Five written vowels
A E I O U say *ah, eh, ee, oh, oo*. Children learn to read by singing the syllables: *ba be bi bo bu, da de di do du…*

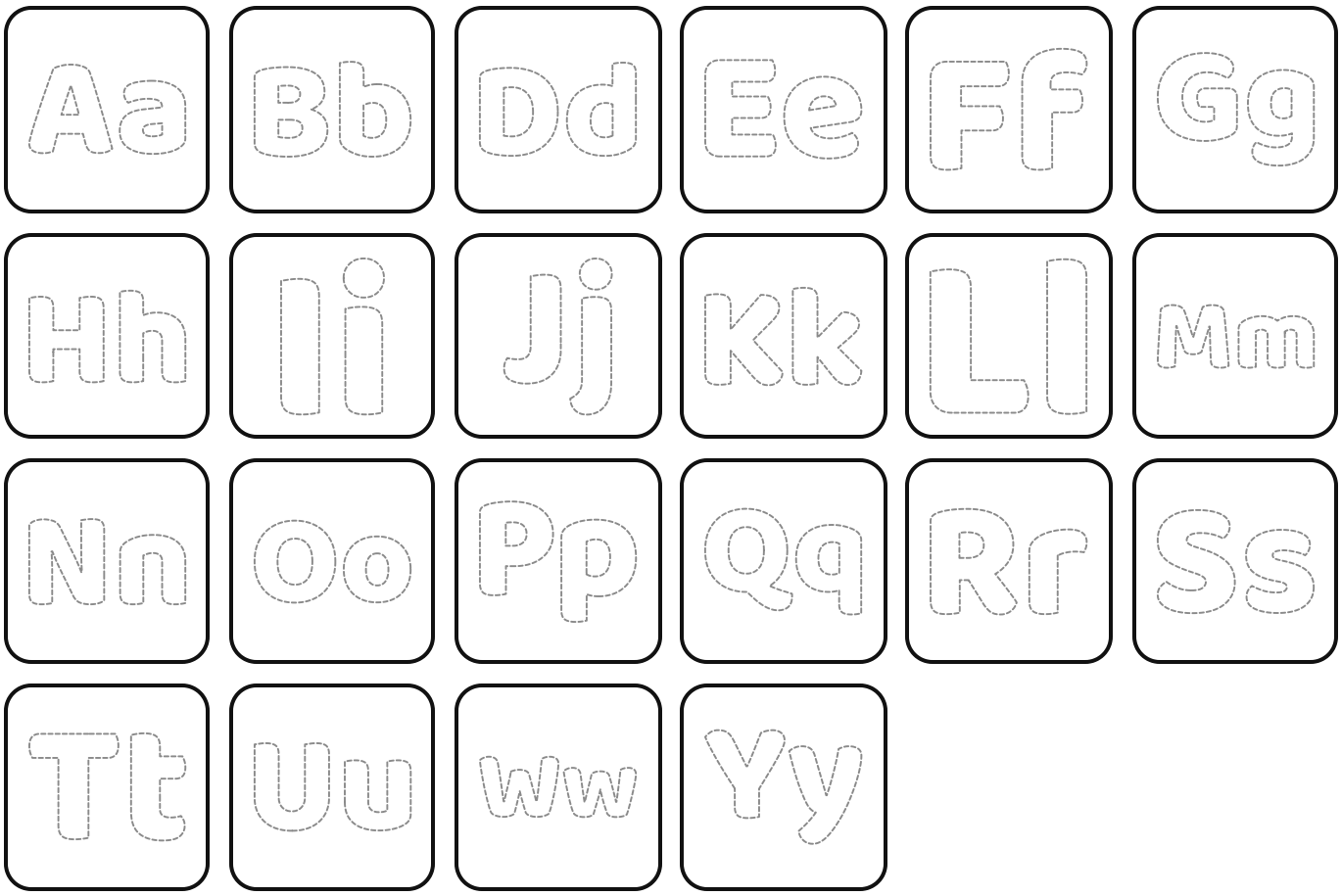
Letter friends
Many sounds are written with two or three letters: **hl, kg, ng, ny, ph, th, kh, tl, ts, sh, tj, tjh**. And **Q** is a **click**!

Big and small
Each page shows the **capital letter** and the **small letter** side by side: **Aa**. Color both!

PENCIL WARM-UP

Trace the letters alfabete ya Sesotho

Use a **pencil**. Say each letter's name as you trace it.



Aa

NAME · LEBITSO

a

ah

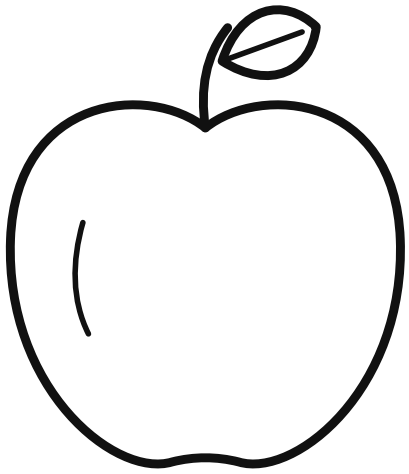
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘a’ as in “father”

SESOTHO NAME · SYLLABLES

A a — «a»

ba · da · ka · ma



AA **IS FOR**

apole

ah-POH-leh

apple

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · NGOLA

Aa Aa Aa Aa

This page is left blank on purpose, so your colours don’t bleed through. ✿

Bb

NAME · LEBITSO

ba

bah

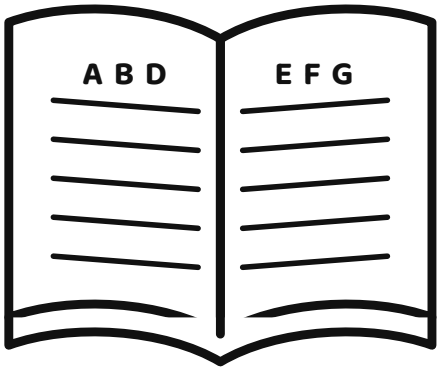
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘b’ as in “ball” (softer between vowels)

SESOTHO NAME · SYLLABLES

B b — «ba»

ba · be · bi · bo · bu



BB IS FOR

buka

BOO-kah

book

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · NGOLA

Bb Bb Bb Bb

This page is left blank on purpose, so your colours don’t bleed through. ✿

Dd

NAME · LEBITSO

da

dah

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

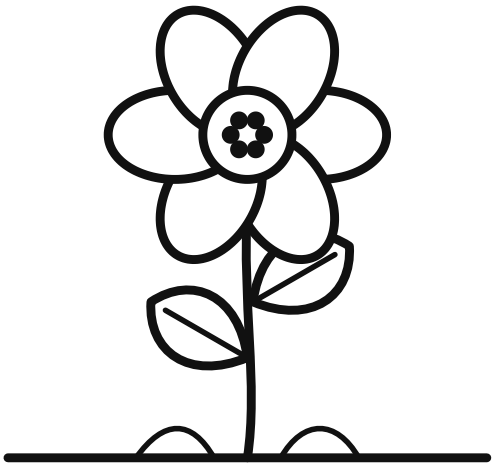
‘d’ as in “door” — only before i and u

SESOTHO NAME · SYLLABLES

D d — «da»

da · de · di · do · du

di and du: the sound of L changes to D before i and u



DD IS FOR

dipalesa

dee-pah-LEH-sah

flowers

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · NGOLA

Dd Dd Dd Dd

This page is left blank on purpose, so your colours don’t bleed through. ✿

Ee

NAME · LEBITSO

e

eh

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

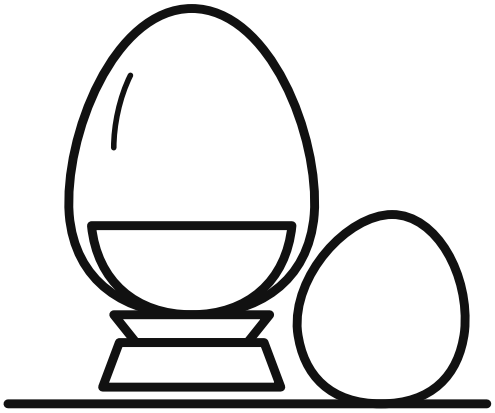
'e' as in "bed" (or a little closer, as in "day")

SESOTHO NAME · SYLLABLES

E e — «e»

be · de · ke · me

Very few Sesotho words start with E. Find it twice in *lehe*!



EE IS FOR

lehe

LEH-heh

egg

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · NGOLA

Ee Ee Ee Ee

This page is left blank on purpose, so your colours don’t bleed through. ✿

Ff

NAME · LEBITSO

fa

fah

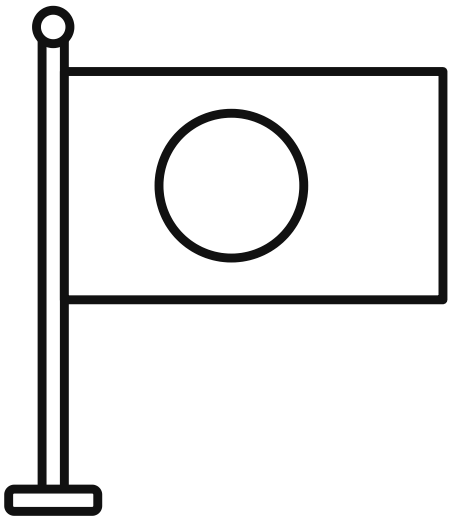
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘f’ as in “fan”

SESOTHO NAME · SYLLABLES

F f — «fa»

fa · fe · fi · fo · fu



FF IS FOR

folaga

foh-LAH-gah

flag

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · NGOLA

Ff Ff Ff Ff

This page is left blank on purpose, so your colours don’t bleed through. ✿

Gg

NAME · LEBITSO

ga

gah

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

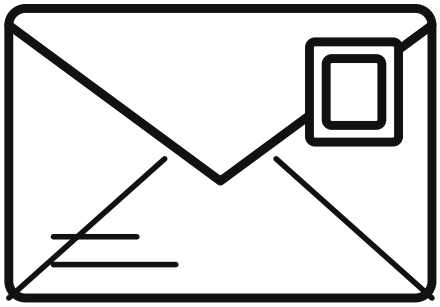
‘g’ as in “go” — mostly in NG, as in “singer”

SESOTHO NAME · SYLLABLES

G g — «ga»

ga · ge · gi · go · gu

G hardly ever stands alone in Sesotho. Look for **ng** in *le**ng**olo*.



GG IS FOR

lengolo

leh-NGOH-loh

letter (to post)

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · NGOLA

Gg Gg Gg Gg

This page is left blank on purpose, so your colours don’t bleed through. ✿

Hh

NAME · LEBITSO

ha

hah

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

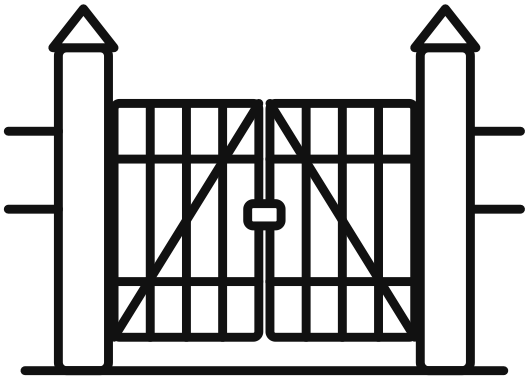
‘h’ as in “hat”

SESOTHO NAME · SYLLABLES

H h — «ha»

ha · he · hi · ho · hu

hl = blow air past the sides of your tongue · ph, th, kh = with a puff of air



HH IS FOR

heke

HEH-keh

gate

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · NGOLA

Hh Hh Hh Hh

This page is left blank on purpose, so your colours don’t bleed through. ✿

Ii

NAME · LEBITSO

i

ee

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

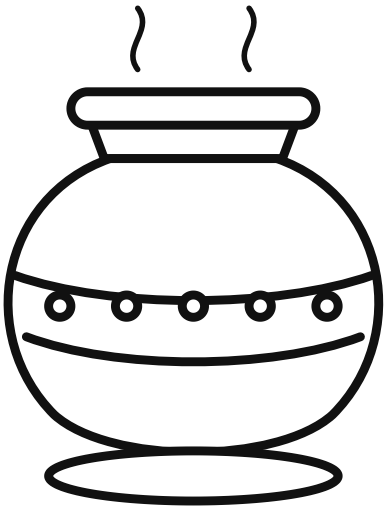
‘ee’ as in “see”

SESOTHO NAME · SYLLABLES

l i — «i»

bi · di · ki · mi

Very few Sesotho naming words start with I. Find it inside *pitsa*!



II IS FOR

pitsa

PEE-tsah

cooking pot

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · NGOLA

This page is left blank on purpose, so your colours don’t bleed through. ✿

Jj

NAME · LEBITSO

ja

jah

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

'j' as in "jam"

SESOTHO NAME · SYLLABLES

J j — «ja»

ja · je · ji · jo · ju



JJ IS FOR

jwang

JWAHNG

grass

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · NGOLA

Jj Jj Jj Jj

This page is left blank on purpose, so your colours don’t bleed through. ✿

Kk

NAME · LEBITSO

ka

kah

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘k’ as in “kite” (no puff of air)

SESOTHO NAME · SYLLABLES

K k — «ka»

ka · ke · ki · ko · ku

kg = a ‘k’ with a throaty ‘h’: **kg**wedi (moon)



KK IS FOR

kopi

KOH-pee

cup

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · NGOLA

Kk Kk Kk Kk

This page is left blank on purpose, so your colours don’t bleed through. ✿

Ll

NAME · LEBITSO

la

lah

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

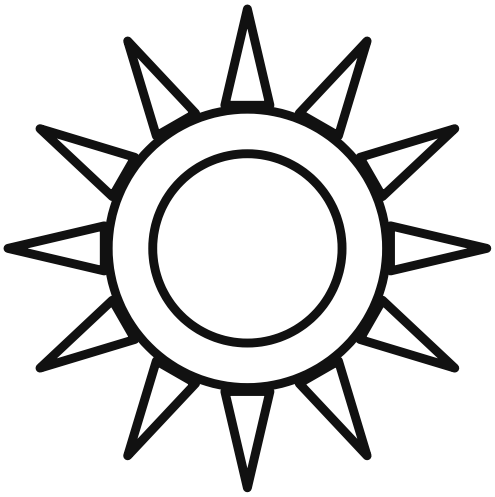
‘l’ as in “lamp”

SESOTHO NAME · SYLLABLES

L l — «la»

la · le · li · lo · lu

ts = ‘ts’ as in “cats” · tl = a ‘t’ and ‘l’ together



LL IS FOR

letsatsi

leh-TSAH-tsee

sun

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · NGOLA

Ll Ll Ll Ll

This page is left blank on purpose, so your colours don’t bleed through. ✿

Mm

NAME · LEBITSO

ma

mah

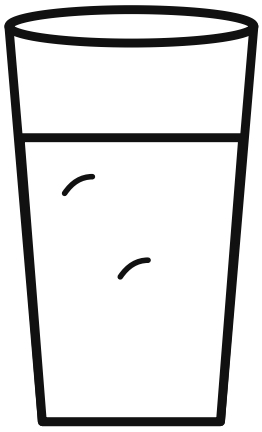
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘m’ as in “moon”; it can be a syllable on its own

SESOTHO NAME · SYLLABLES

M m — «ma»

ma · me · mi · mo · mu



MM IS FOR

metsi

MEH-tsee

water

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · NGOLA

Mm Mm Mm Mm

This page is left blank on purpose, so your colours don’t bleed through. ✿

Nn

NAME · LEBITSO

na

nah

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

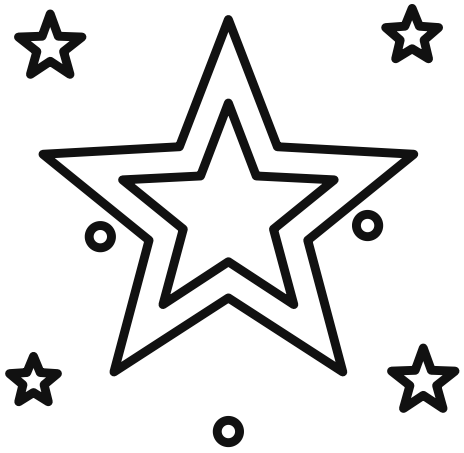
‘n’ as in “net”

SESOTHO NAME · SYLLABLES

N n — «na»

na · ne · ni · no · nu

ny = ‘ny’ as in “canyon” · ng = ‘ng’ as in “singer”



NN IS FOR

naledi

nah-LEH-dee

star

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · NGOLA

Nn Nn Nn Nn

This page is left blank on purpose, so your colours don’t bleed through. ✿

Oo

NAME · LEBITSO

O

oh

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

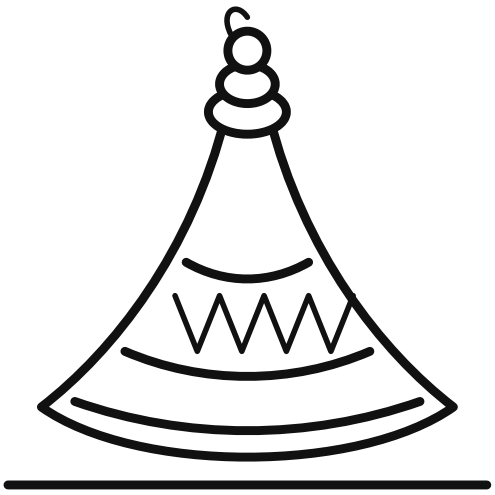
‘o’ as in “for” (or closer, as in “go”)

SESOTHO NAME · SYLLABLES

O o — «o»

bo · do · ko · mo

Very few Sesotho words start with O, but you can find it four times in *mokorotlo*!



OO IS FOR

mokorotlo

moh-koh-ROH-tloh

the Basotho grass hat

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · NGOLA

Oo Oo Oo Oo

This page is left blank on purpose, so your colours don’t bleed through. ✿

Pp

NAME · LEBITSO

pa

pah

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘p’ as in “spin” (no puff of air)

SESOTHO NAME · SYLLABLES

P p — «pa»

pa · pe · pi · po · pu



PP IS FOR

pula

POO-lah

rain

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · NGOLA

Pp Pp Pp Pp

This page is left blank on purpose, so your colours don’t bleed through. ✿

Qq

NAME · LEBITSO

qa

(click) ah

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

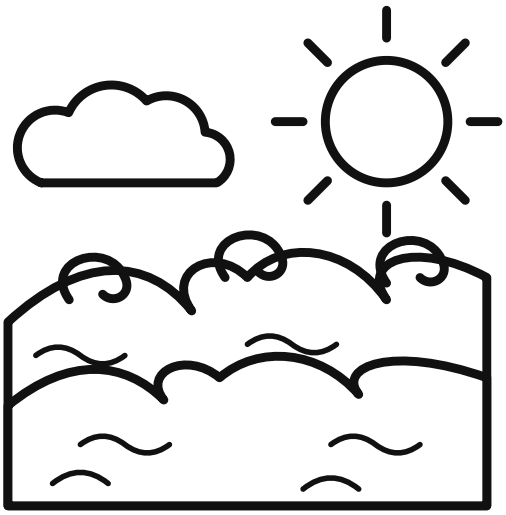
a click! Pop your tongue off the roof of your mouth

SESOTHO NAME · SYLLABLES

Q q — «qa»

qa · qe · qi · qo · qu

Q is a **click** sound, borrowed from neighbouring languages such as Zulu and Xhosa. Find it inside *maqhubu*!



QQ IS FOR

maqhubu

mah-(click)HOO-boo

waves

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · NGOLA

Qq Qq Qq Qq

This page is left blank on purpose, so your colours don’t bleed through. ✿

Rr

NAME · LEBITSO

ra

rah

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

a rolled ‘r’, sometimes from the throat

SESOTHO NAME · SYLLABLES

R r — «ra»

ra · re · ri · ro · ru



RR **IS FOR**

raese

RAH-eh-seh

rice

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · NGOLA

Rr Rr Rr Rr

This page is left blank on purpose, so your colours don’t bleed through. ✿

Ss Ss

NAME · LEBITSO

sa

sah

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

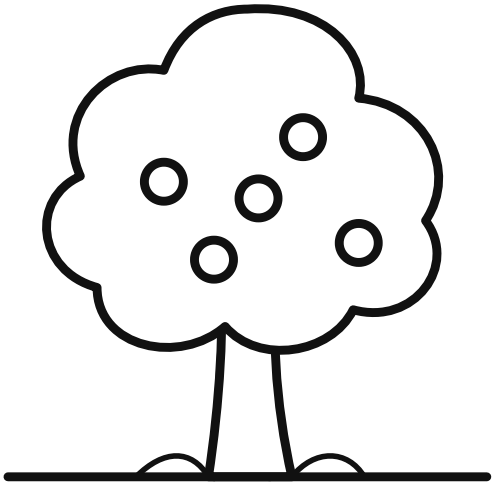
‘s’ as in “sun”

SESOTHO NAME · SYLLABLES

S s — «sa»

sa · se · si · so · su

sh = ‘sh’ as in “ship”



SS IS FOR

sefate

seh-FAH-teh

tree

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · NGOLA

Ss Ss Ss Ss

This page is left blank on purpose, so your colours don’t bleed through. ✿

Tt

NAME · LEBITSO

ta

tah

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

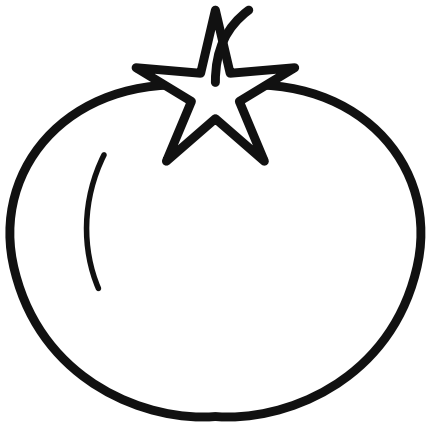
‘t’ as in “stop” (no puff of air)

SESOTHO NAME · SYLLABLES

T t — «ta»

ta · te · ti · to · tu

th = a ‘t’ with a puff of air · tjh = ‘ch’ with a puff of air



TT IS FOR

tamati

tah-MAH-tee

tomato

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · NGOLA

Tt Tt Tt Tt

This page is left blank on purpose, so your colours don’t bleed through. ✿

Uu

NAME · LEBITSO

u

oo

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

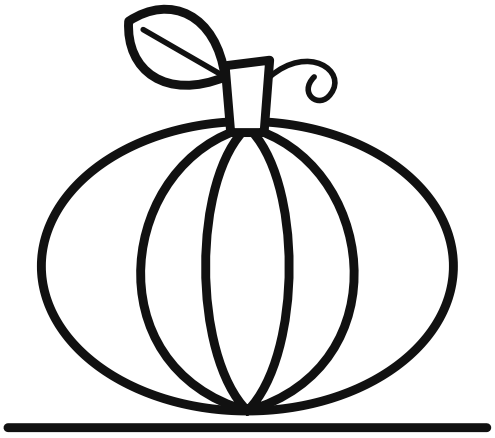
‘oo’ as in “moon”

SESOTHO NAME · SYLLABLES

U u — «u»

bu · du · ku · mu

Very few Sesotho words start with U. Find it at the end of *mokopu*!



UU IS FOR

mokopu

moh-KOH-poo

pumpkin

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · NGOLA

Uu Uu Uu Uu

This page is left blank on purpose, so your colours don’t bleed through. ✿

Ww

NAME · LEBITSO

wa

wah

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘w’ as in “water”

SESOTHO NAME · SYLLABLES

W w — «wa»

wa · we · wi · wo · wu

W often sits after another letter: *kg**w**edi*, *j**w**ang*.



WW **IS FOR**

kgwedi

KHWEH-dee

moon

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · NGOLA

Ww Ww Ww Ww

This page is left blank on purpose, so your colours don’t bleed through. ✿

Yy

NAME · LEBITSO

ya

yah

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

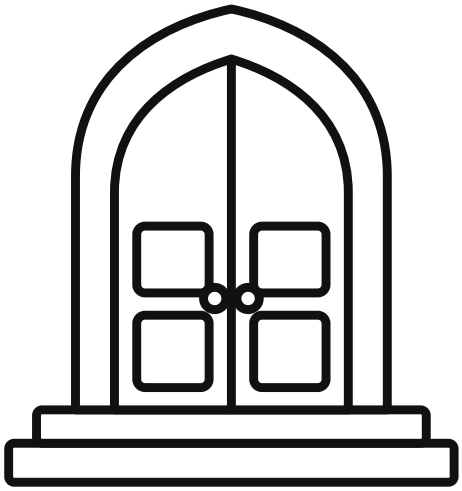
‘y’ as in “yes”

SESOTHO NAME · SYLLABLES

Y y — «ya»

ya · ye · yi · yo · yu

Y hardly ever starts a Sesotho naming word. Find it in the pair **ny** of *mo**ny**ako*!



YY IS FOR

monyako

moh-NYAH-koh

door, doorway

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · NGOLA

Yy Yy Yy Yy

This page is left blank on purpose, so your colours don’t bleed through. ✿

BONUS

Sesotho numbers dinomoro *(dee-noh-MOH-roh)*

Color the numbers and count out loud in Sesotho: *leh-FEH-lah*, *N-ngweh*, *PEH-dee*, *TAH-roh*...



This page is left blank on purpose, so your colours don’t bleed through. ✿

LET'S TALK

My first Sesotho words Mantswe a pele

Now that you know the letters, try saying these with your family.

Assalamu alaikum

as-sah-LAH-moo ah-LAI-koom
Peace be upon you (the Muslim greeting)

Wa alaikum assalam

wah ah-LAI-koom as-sah-LAHM
And peace be upon you (the reply)

Dumela!

doo-MEH-lah
Hello!

Lebitso la ka ke ...

leh-BEE-tsoh lah kah keh ...
My name is ...

Ke a leboha

keh ah leh-BOH-hah
Thank you

Jazakallahu khairan

jah-zah-KAHL-lah-hoo KHAI-rahn
May Allah reward you with good

mme · ntate

M-meh · n-TAH-teh
Mother · Father

abuti · ausi

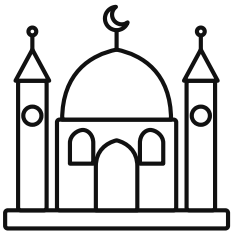
ah-BOO-tee · ah-OO-see
Brother · Sister

e · tjhe

eh · CHEH
Yes · No

Ke ithuta Sesotho!

keh ee-TOO-tah seh-SOO-too
I am learning Sesotho!







REFERENCES & SOURCES

Where our facts come from

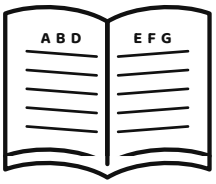
[1] **The Noble Qur'an** — Surah Ar-Raḥmān 55:1–4, Surah Ar-Rūm 30:22 and Surah Al-Ḥujurāt 49:13. Arabic text and meanings checked against **Quran.com**; the English meanings in this book are simplified for children.

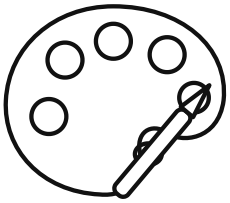
[2] **Map** — outlines from **Natural Earth** (public domain), via the *world-atlas* data set.

[3] **Language facts** — speaker numbers from **Ethnologue** (SIL International), rounded.

What's next?
You have met all **22 Sesotho letters**! Keep practising by reading signs, books and food packets written in Sesotho, and look out for the other books in the **Allamahul Bayan Series**, in shā' Allāh.

Enjoyed this book?
A short review on Amazon helps other families find it — *jazākumullāhu khayran!*







Certificate of Achievement

Mashallah! O entse hantle!

MAH-shah-lah! oh EHN-tseh HAHN-tleh! — Mashallah! You did well!

This certifies that

_____

has learned, traced and colored
all 22 letters of the Sesotho alphabet.

_____ Date

_____ Grown-up's signature

Minhaz Reza

Hafez Abdullah Muhammad Minhaz Reza, author

Maktabatu Kunujul Akhirah — Publisher
An imprint of the Kunujul Akhirah Charitable Trust
مكتبة كنوز الآخرة

✂ Cut out and frame it — the back of this page is blank.